

6 290100 002316

MONDAY
JUNE 8, 2026
DHU AL HIJJA 22, 1447

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS



LIVE
UPDATES

The Bridge To Your Home



Cargo, Courier,
Shipping, logistics

800 916
www.abccargo.com

3154585 1361



GMO

FILIPINOS MARK INDEPENDENCE DAY IN DUBAI

Filipino spirit came alive in Dubai through music, food, dance, and tradition as thousands gathered to celebrate Kalayaan 2026, a major community event marking the 128th anniversary of Philippine Independence Day. Held at the Dubai World Trade Centre yesterday, the event drew an estimated 40,000 attendees, making it one of the largest Filipino community gatherings in the UAE.

SEE ALSO P5

UAE retail market to hit \$227b by 2033 on tourism boom

Reports highlight Dubai's continued dominance in the luxury retail segment

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

The UAE has cemented its position as one of the world's leading retail destinations, underpinned by a fast-growing and diversified economy, world-class infrastructure, and an integrated ecosystem that combines mega shopping malls, digital commerce and advanced logistics services.

International reports increasingly point to the UAE as a global benchmark for building flexible and innovative retail ecosystems that place consumer experience at the centre of development strategies, reinforcing the country's role as a regional and international hub

5.1%

Expected compound annual growth rate of UAE retail market

for shopping, business and investment.

A 2025 report by the Inter-Regional for Strategic Analysis - MIR projected that the UAE retail market would reach \$227.1 billion by 2033, supported by a compound annual growth rate of 5.1 per cent. Meanwhile, research group IMARC estimated the market size at \$152.7 billion in 2025 and forecast growth to \$237.7 billion by 2034.

According to the UAE's official news agency, WAM, research firm TechSci said the UAE's status as a global tourism and shopping destination, coupled with its high-end retail centres and concentration of in-

ternational brands, continues to support strong retail revenues.

One of the largest

Dubai's retail market, regarded as one of the largest in the world, is also maintaining its momentum. A report by real estate consultancy Cushman & Wakefield said the sector is expanding across all segments and enters 2026 with significant depth and dynamism, making it one of the most resilient and diversified retail markets globally.

The report highlighted Dubai's continued dominance in the luxury retail segment, with Fashion Avenue at Dubai Mall ranked 11th worldwide in terms of retail rents.

According to market research firm Mordor Intelligence, the UAE luxury goods market is estimated at \$8.5 billion in 2025 and is expected to rise to \$11.86 billion by 2031, reflecting a compound annual growth rate of 5.7 per cent between 2026 and 2031.

Europe border checks cause six-hour airport waits: IATA

Airlines cite delays, missed flights, EES rollout challenges

RIO DE JANEIRO
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Europe's new Entry/Exit System (EES) could trigger airport waits of up to six hours this summer as border authorities struggle with the rollout of the digital registration programme, the International Air Transport Association (IATA) warned.

"We are already seeing delays and misconnections in Portugal, Spain, Italy, Greece, Belgium, and elsewhere," Rafael Schwartzman, IATA Regional Vice-President for Europe, said at the group's

annual meeting in Rio de Janeiro. "Without action, these problems will worsen over the summer and cause major disruption for passengers."

Biometric registration

The EES replaces manual passport stamping with biometric registration for non-EU travellers entering the Schengen zone. Schwartzman said passengers were already missing flights and connections, with expected waits now reaching "three, four, five, six hours".

Processing times have increased from around 20-25 seconds to 90 seconds per passenger, IATA said. "If it works, it's 90 seconds. If it doesn't work, then how long does it take?" Schwartzman asked.

SEE ALSO P8

TRUMP SAYS TROOPS TO STAY AS IRAN WAR HITS 100 DAYS

No sanctions relief or asset release before deal

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump said yesterday he has no plans to withdraw the roughly 50,000 American troops involved in the Iran conflict until "we have a completion" in the country, signalling that Washington remains committed to maintaining a major military presence despite ongoing diplomatic efforts.

Trump's comments came as the Middle East marked 100 days since the United States and Israel launched military strikes on Iran, with fresh clashes and stalled diplomacy keeping the region on edge. The US military said it shot down two Iranian attack drones near the Strait of Hormuz late Saturday, while Iran fired missiles toward Bahrain and Kuwait earlier.

"I don't consider [the troops] in danger," Trump said in an interview with NBC's Meet the Press. "We have the best defence anyone's ever seen. We have the best offence anyone's ever seen."

He said withdrawing troops would be "foolhardy" and compared casualties in the Iran operation to previous US wars.

Trump also offered a positive assessment of Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, describing him as "more rational" than his predecessor while suggesting he had been injured during the conflict.

UAE URGES NUCLEAR SITE PROTECTION

The UAE has urged the international community to strengthen protections for civilian nuclear infrastructure after a terrorist drone attack targeting the Barakah Nuclear Energy Plant, warning that assaults on peaceful nuclear facilities pose a serious threat to regional and global security.

Speaking during an extraordinary meeting of the Board of Governors of the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA), Abdullah Balalaa, Assistant Minister of Foreign Affairs for Energy and Sustainability Affairs, condemned the attack. "Targeting peaceful nuclear power plants constitutes a clear violation of international law, the United Nations Charter and international humanitarian law," he said. The emergency session was convened following a request submitted by Egypt, Jordan, Morocco and Saudi Arabia.

— Gulf News Report

'Surgical' approach in Lebanon

The US president said he remained broadly aligned with Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, despite disagreements over Lebanon. While backing Israel's campaign against Hezbollah, Trump said he would prefer a more "surgical" approach against the Iran-backed group.

His remarks came as Israel struck Beirut's southern suburbs yesterday, saying it targeted Hezbollah command centres after rockets were fired toward northern Israel.

On diplomacy, Trump made clear that Washington was not prepared to offer major concessions before a peace agreement is reached. He said the United States would not unfreeze Iranian assets or lift sanctions ahead of a deal. "Comes after," Trump said when asked whether sanctions relief could precede an agreement. He also said

he was not insisting that Lebanon be included in any short-term arrangement with Tehran.

Diplomacy continues

Meanwhile, Pakistan's Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi visited Tehran and met Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, delivering a written message from Pakistan's Defence Forces Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir to Khamenei. According to Araghchi's Telegram channel, the two sides discussed bilateral ties and efforts to end the conflict.

Separately, CBS News reported that the US Treasury Department is exploring whether frozen Iranian assets could be used to help Gulf allies repair damage caused during the conflict. Treasury officials are said to be examining the legal and practical options, although no decision has been announced.

SEE ALSO P11

NATION
Dubai's new Harbour Bridge to cut travel time from 12 to 3 minutes | P2



SPORT
Dubai Basketball one win away from historic title | P13

10X
Properties

10X LAND
EXPO 2026
JUNE 13, 2026

SCAN FOR
REGISTRATION

YOUR GATEWAY TO
AED 100 BILLION
WORTH OF INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES
IN THE UAE

Strictly by invitation and appointment only
No walk-ins

TOLL FREE / WHATSAPP
+971 800 801 802

sales@10xproperties.ae

3154585 1361